

The tablet showed pretty decent improvement over last year's Xiaomi Pad 5 and even managed to beat the latest OnePlus Pad in a few CPU-based benchmark tests. It is important to note here that the OnePlus Pad starts at ₹37,999, so the Xiaomi Pad 6 beats out a tablet that costs about ₹9,000 more than the Xiaomi Pad 6. Good. In Geekbench 6 and PC Mark Work 3.0, the Xiaomi Pad 6 beats the OnePlus Pad, which also has a newer chip, the MediaTek Dimensity 9000.

We also tried to run GPU-based benchmarks on the Xiaomi Pad 6, but weren't able to run them since Xiaomi products usually have these benchmarks blacklisted for some reason. However, I did play games on the Xiaomi Pad 6 and my experience was pretty good. Yes, playing mobile games on a bigger screen feels a bit odd since I'm used to the smaller screen on games like Call of Duty: Mobile and the likes, but the games ran very smoothly and at times, the bigger screen helped in making things more visible.

Keeping the testing and benchmarks aside, I used the Xiaomi Pad 6 for work, entertainment, and gaming. And in all three areas, the tablet performed pretty well. I took the Xiaomi Pad 6 on a work trip and used it as my only work and entertainment device for about 2 days with the keyboard and the Xiaomi Pencil. The experience was as good as any other tablet I have used in the past. I was able to write and research at the same time. Further, the Xiaomi Pencil also works pretty well. While I'm not much of an artist, I loved using the pencil in attempts of unleashing my creative side. The latency is very good, and the pencil is also pressure sensitive, along with shortcut control. Pretty cool.

There are other convenience and productivity features on the Xiaomi Pad 6, like this new phone connectivity feature. Now, while it is a very convenient feature for those who want to transfer files or sync data from their smartphones to their tablets, or even cast their smartphone screen, but the feature is only limited to the Xiaomi 13 Pro smartphone for now, which means it basically doesn't exist for the majority of people who will go ahead and buy this device. Apart from this, the

Xiaomi Pad 6 also comes with 4K output, meaning that if you connect it with a 4K display, the tablet's output will be in the full 4K resolution. Very cool.

Apart from this, Xiaomi has also done well to keep the keyboard shortcuts very similar to what we use on a Windows laptop. Being a Windows user, I can appreciate this feature and how much it affects the productivity or the ease of working on this tablet, but you will really miss a trackpad more often than not. Another reason why I'd prefer the trackpad is that having one leaves borders below the keyboard setup for you to rest your palms. Yes, it doesn't really matter on a flat surface like a desk or a tabletop, but since I used this on my lap a lot, I missed that extra space to rest my palms and keep the tablet balanced at the same time.

Coming to battery, the Xiaomi Pad 6's battery is an 8,840mAh unit, which is pretty big on paper. In our battery tests, however, the results were a bit mixed. For example, the Xiaomi Pad 6 lost a whopping 12 percent of the battery while using GPS navigation for 1 hour. While playing Call of Duty Mobile for 15 minutes, the tablet lost about 5 percent of the battery, and while streaming HDR content for 30 minutes, the Xiaomi Pad 6 lost 8 percent of the battery. This, despite the large 8,840mAh unit, doesn't really show good battery optimisation.

Coming to charging, the Xiaomi Pad 6 comes with 33W fast charging, which charges the tablet from 0 to 100 in about 124 minutes or 2 hours and 4 minutes. Now, while this is not the fastest charging we have seen on a tablet, it is not too bad for a large 8,840mAh battery.

CAMERA

Coming to cameras, the camera on the Xiaomi Pad 6 is average. The rear camera is something that won't be used as much as the front camera, so having an average quality isn't really a deal breaker. However, the images from the rear camera aren't really good per se. The photos are usually more hazy and lack a certain level of detail and sharpness. The colours also seem quite washed out from this 13-megapixel shooter.

The front camera, on the other hand, is an 8-megapixel shooter, which is good for 1080p video recording at 30FPS. This also isn't very good if we compare it with some other, more premium devices, but for your video calls and online meetings, this does the job pretty well. Yes, the selfies won't be as good as a smartphone, but for other tasks, this will get the job done pretty well.

VERDICT

So that was my review of the Xiaomi Pad 6. The tablet is promising and offers a pretty decent upgrade over last year's Xiaomi Pad 5. We get a better chip, a more responsive and vibrant display, and a marginally bigger battery.

The design is also pretty handy and compact and it does look like the iPad Air from the front. Even the default wallpaper looks inspired by the iPad Air's wallpaper, but I'm not sure if that's exactly a bad thing. The display and performance are pretty good, but the battery optimisation and camera are just about average.

Xiaomi has also put a lot of effort into providing convenience and productivity features, but there are a few things here and there that require an explanation or better compatibility. Furthermore, there are things you can't help but miss like a trackpad on the additional keyboard accessory and cellular connectivity, but these are things you'll only miss if you are a certain type of user. Overall, the Xiaomi Pad 6 is a nice product and I had a good time consuming content and working on this tablet. What remains to be seen is if Xiaomi has enough stocks, in case this enjoys the same level of popularity as its predecessor.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Display Size: 27.94cm(11) | Resolution: 2880*1800 | Refresh rate: 144Hz | Brightness : 550nits (typ) | Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon™ 870 | Rear camera: 13MP | Front camera: 8 MP | Battery: 8840mAh | Connectivity: Bluetooth 5.2

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